The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter

Photograph: AFP

Viktor Orban, **Hungary's** prime minister since 2010, conceded defeat in the country's parliamentary elections. Despite years spent reshaping the electoral system to favour his Fidesz party, Tisza, led by Peter Magyar, has won comfortably. Turnout exceeded 77%, according to the National Election Office—the highest in any election since the fall of communism.

Donald Trump said America would begin a blockade of the **Strait of Hormuz** after peace talks with Iran broke down. Writing on social media, he said the navy would clear the strait of mines, warning that "any Iranian who fires at us, or at peaceful vessels, will be BLOWN TO HELL!" The president also said he had ordered the navy to interdict any ship in international waters that had paid a toll to Iran.

Commenting on **the negotiations**, Mr Trump said they "went well" and that "most points were agreed to", except the "only point that really mattered, NUCLEAR". Earlier J.D. Vance, America's vice-president, who led the American delegation, suggested Iran had refused to make "an affirmative commitment" not to "seek a nuclear weapon". Iran's top negotiator accused the Americans of having "failed to gain the trust of the Iranian delegation".

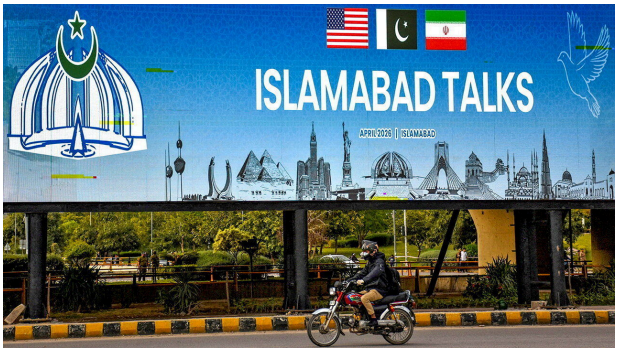
An air strike by **Nigeria's** air force targeting Boko Haram militants reportedly killed more than 100 civilians at a market in the country's north-east. The air force said it had killed Islamist rebels in the area, and was investigating non-combatant casualties. More than 500 civilians have been killed in such strikes since 2017, according to the Associated Press.

China said it would resume direct flights to **Taiwan** and begin to import some fish and seafood from the island. The easing of restrictions comes after Cheng Li-wun, Taiwan's China-friendly opposition leader, met Xi Jinping, China's leader, in Beijing on Friday. That same day, Taiwan's defence ministry said that it spotted 16 Chinese warplanes flying near the island.

The **Philippines** demanded that **Meta**, the parent company of Facebook and Instagram, take action to restrict "false and panic-inducing content" on its platforms. Among the offending items were faked warnings about the economy and forged medical documents purporting to be those of the president. The country threatened "appropriate regulatory and legal measures" if Meta did not take swift action.

Asha Bhosle, a singer who provided much of the soundtrack to Bollywood over her more than eight-decade career, died, aged 92. Ms Bhosle recorded over 12,000 songs in 20 Indian languages, making her the most recorded artist in history. She lent her voice to innumerable different styles, both classic and modern, imbuing each with drama and pathos.

Word of the week: *Boondoggle*, what the International Thermonuclear Experimental Reactor has become. Read the full story.



Photograph: Reuters

Pakistan’s strategic statecraft

As America and Iran failed to strike a deal in Islamabad, Pakistan’s capital, on Sunday, it should not be forgotten that the hosts had plenty riding on a positive outcome too. Denounced by Donald Trump during his first term as a country of only “lies and deceit”, Pakistan’s government has carefully courted America’s president in his second term. It has offered the country as a hub for cryptocurrency and critical minerals, and nominated Mr Trump for the Nobel peace prize. He now calls Asim Munir, Pakistan’s powerful army chief, his “favourite field marshal”.

Pakistan must also maintain a delicate balance with Iran. The countries share a 900km border, which Iranian refugees could spill over if the war restarts. Meanwhile Pakistan depends on the Gulf for its oil and gas, as well as remittances from 5.5m Pakistani workers. But even just hosting the talks was a morale-booster for a country which has suffered floods, insurgencies and soaring inflation, not to mention a war with India.

Photograph: Getty Images

Hungary’s rebuke to populism

Hungary, a middle-tier member of the European Union, has long punched above its weight in the bloc’s affairs under Viktor Orban. He has held up aid to Ukraine and clashed with the EU over the rule of law. That era is now ending. In parliamentary elections on Sunday Mr Orban’s Fidesz party lost to Tisza, led by Peter Magyar. “Europe’s heart is beating stronger in Hungary tonight,” tweeted Ursula von der Leyen, president of the European Commission, after the result.

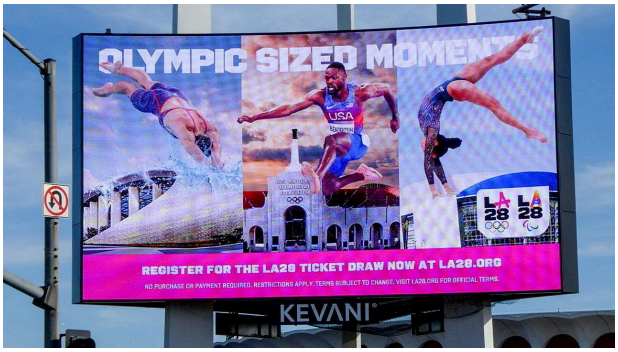
Admired by America’s MAGA movement and right-wing populists across Europe, Mr Orban was courted by the Trump administration and maintained close ties with the Kremlin. During his 16 years in power he became a model for illiberal leaders, showing how to capture state institutions while preserving a semblance of democracy. Liberals, at home and abroad, cheered. Yet even as he conceded, Mr Orban vowed: “We are not giving up. Never, never, never.”

Photograph: AP

Peru’s historically large ballot

A record 35 candidates are competing in Peru’s presidential election, which begins on Sunday amid a surge in crime and corruption. Most polling puts Keiko Fujimori, Peru’s law-and-order contender, in the lead on about 13%—far from the 50% needed to win. Next come Carlos Álvarez, a comedian who wants to introduce the death penalty, and Ricardo Belmont, an octogenarian ex-mayor of Lima who says he will tackle crime with “hugs, not bullets”. Another former mayor of the capital, Rafael López Aliaga, an admirer of Donald Trump, recently fell to fourth place. Many candidates are obscure. Some warn that such a large ballot will confuse voters.

Peru has had nine presidents in the past decade, most of whom were impeached or resigned. A disillusioned and divided electorate makes a run-off almost inevitable—bad news for Ms Fujimori, who has lost the past three. Her detractors joke that she is so unpopular she would lose against a loaf of sweet bread, a local treat.



Photograph: Alamy

Heat is reshaping the Olympics

Tickets for the 2028 Olympic Games in Los Angeles went on sale to the general public this weekend. They are not cheap: seats for popular events already run into the thousands, and even the most affordable “local” tickets cost far more (in real terms) than at the city’s last Games in 1984. But rising prices may not be the biggest concern.

Rising temperatures are. During the 1980s the highest temperature recorded in August was 40.5°C (105°F); the average for the decades was 35.7°C—hot enough to worry athletes even then. Today, such conditions look less exceptional. In March this year, Palm Springs hit 42°C during a severe heatwave.

That does not bode well for 2028. Intense heat raises the risk of dehydration and heat stroke, especially during endurance events. And as climate change pushes temperatures higher, competing in extreme conditions is becoming the norm. The past two Summer Games, in Tokyo and Paris, were both among the hottest on record.

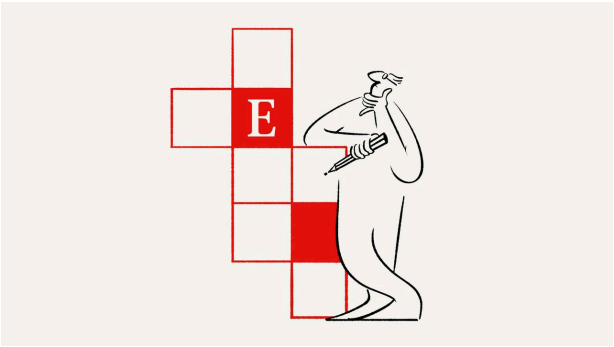


Illustration: The Economist

Mini crossword

We publish a new interactive edition of our crossword daily, allowing you to enter and check the answers and see explanations. Try it here. Or, if you prefer, use the clues below.

There are two sets of clues, one for seasoned cruciverbalists and the other for less experienced solvers. Both give the same answers.

Cryptic clues

1 across - Keen to be included in the age requirement (5)

2 across - The Irish expel royal successor (4)

3 across - The night before, not excluding ring ceremony (5)

1 down - Rare is the beguiling appearance of our planet beyond the moon (9)

Straight clues

1 across - Enthusiastic, hankering (5)

2 across - Next in line or beneficiary (4)

3 across - Gathering, occasion (5)

1 down - (Picture of) our home ascending from the horizon of the Moon (9)

Illustration: Sandra Navarro

The winners of this week's quiz

Thank you to everyone who took part in this week's quiz. The winners, chosen at random, were:

Emilio Ferreira, Buenos Aires, Argentina

Adele & Ted Pelletier, Portland, Oregon

Frank Janssen, Brussels, Belgium

They all gave the correct answers of: Christine Lagarde, the Greens, Carrie Fisher, Salem and The Dead. The theme is Stephen King novels: Christine, The Green Mile, Carrie, 'Salem's Lot and The Dead Zone.

The questions were:

Monday: Who is the President of the European Central Bank?

Tuesday: Which political party won the largest shares of the vote in the recent Baden-Wũrttemburg regional election?

Wednesday: Which actress played Princess Leia in the Star Wars films?

Thursday: In which Massachusetts town did witch trials occur in 1692-93?

Friday: Which short story by James Joyce was the last, and longest, in his Dubliners collection?

The only reason for being a professional writer is that you can’t help it.

Leo Rosten